

Global Markets Update

Thursday, 30 April 2026 · Prepared for CFD Clients · FSCA-Regulated

CFDs carry significant risk. Capital is at risk. Past performance does not guarantee future results. This is market commentary, not financial advice.

LIVE MARKET SNAPSHOT — 30 APRIL 2026

S&P 500 7,135 −0.04% ↔	NASDAQ 24,673 +0.04% ↑	DOW JONES 48,861 −0.57% ↓	VIX (FEAR) 18.64 +4.55% ↑
GOLD (XAU) \$4,547 −1.33% ↓	WTI OIL \$106.88 +6.92% ↑↑	BITCOIN \$75,276 −1.24% ↓	BRENT CRUDE \$118.03 +6.0% ↑↑

1 What Happened — In Plain English

Imagine the world's oil tap is half-closed. That is essentially what happened yesterday when President Trump said the United States will keep its naval blockade on Iran until Iran agrees to dismantle its nuclear programme. Iran, for its part, has responded by restricting traffic through the Strait of Hormuz — a narrow waterway that carries roughly a fifth of the world's oil. The result was predictable: oil prices jumped roughly 7% in a single day, a move that sends shockwaves through airline stocks, transport companies, and anything that burns fuel to operate.

Meanwhile, four of the biggest technology companies in America — Microsoft, Meta (Facebook's parent), Alphabet (Google), and Amazon — all reported their earnings after the market closed yesterday. The early read is broadly positive: the tech giants collectively plan to spend over \$300 billion on artificial intelligence infrastructure in 2026 alone. That number, while breathtaking, is reassuring to investors because it means confidence in future growth. Tonight, Apple completes the group, reporting after the market closes.

For the broader stock market, it was a mixed and slightly nervous session. The Dow fell for the fifth day in a row, dragged down by energy-sensitive companies feeling the pinch of higher oil costs. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq barely moved. The "fear gauge" — a measure of how anxious traders are — rose nearly 5%, which tells us investors are holding their breath ahead of today's big economic data releases and Apple's results.

✓ THE GOOD NEWS

Tech Giants Are Still Investing in the Future

Four of the world's largest companies reported strong quarterly results. Earnings for the "Magnificent Seven" tech group are growing 19% year-on-year — far faster than the rest of the stock market. Alphabet, Meta, Microsoft, and Amazon all guided higher on AI spending, which signals long-term confidence in the economy. For investors, this is the engine still running strong even as the road gets bumpy.

⚠ THE CAUTION — WHAT TO WATCH

Oil at \$106 Changes the Cost of Everything

When oil jumps 7% in one day, the effects ripple everywhere within weeks: petrol prices rise, shipping costs increase, airline tickets go up, and central banks worry about inflation climbing again. The Dow Jones has now fallen five days in a row — a warning sign that "old economy" companies (manufacturers, airlines, retailers) are feeling squeezed. The Strait of Hormuz situation has no clear end date. If oil stays above \$100 for months, it complicates the case for interest-rate cuts.

📺 TONIGHT'S BIGGEST EVENT

Apple Earnings + US Core Inflation Data

Today at 2:30 PM US time (New York), America releases its first estimate of Q1 economic growth (GDP) and its preferred inflation measure (Core PCE). These two numbers will tell us whether the US economy is slowing down or holding up — and

whether interest-rate cuts remain on the table for later this year. Then after markets close, Apple reports. With analysts expecting \$109 billion in revenue, any surprise — good or bad — will move not just Apple's shares, but the entire market.

2 Tier 1 — Starter Guide (\$1,000 – \$3,000 per trade)

STARTER TIER

Simple Trade Ideas for New Investors

Plain English · Easy to follow · Know your limits before you trade

Gold (XAU/USD) — Buy on Dip

LOW RISK

"Gold is like a life jacket. You don't wear it every day, but when the ship rocks, you're glad you have it. Today it dipped — that's the sale."

Gold fell slightly today as some investors sold it to cover oil-related losses elsewhere. But with geopolitical tension rising, gold historically bounces back quickly. Think of this as buying an umbrella on a sunny day — because the forecast shows rain. Gold has been one of the year's best performers and dips like this have tended to recover.

ENTRY AROUND	TARGET	STOP LOSS
\$4,520	\$4,680	\$4,440

Capital	Trade Size	Max Risk	Potential Gain
\$1,000	Small lot	~\$80	~\$160
\$2,000	Medium lot	~\$160	~\$320
\$3,000	Larger lot	~\$240	~\$480

Oil (WTI) — Watch Only / High Caution

HIGH RISK

"Oil right now is like a football match that's already at 3–0 in the 80th minute. Yes, it could go to 4–0. But it can also snap back to 3–1 very fast."

Oil has already jumped nearly 7% in a single day. Chasing a move this large is dangerous — the risk of a snap reversal is high. **For starters, this is a WATCH position only.** If you already hold oil from earlier this week, consider taking partial profits. If you are not in oil, wait for a pullback to \$100–\$102 before considering an entry. Do not buy after a 7% single-day move.

ENTRY ONLY IF	TARGET	STOP LOSS
\$100–102	\$110	\$97

US S&P 500 Index — Small Long, After Apple

MEDIUM RISK

"The S&P 500 is like a big basket of America's 500 best companies. It's been flat for two days — like a runner catching their breath before a sprint."

The index has been holding steady despite the Dow's weakness, which shows underlying resilience. However, with Apple reporting tonight, it is wise to wait until after the announcement. A good Apple result could push the S&P 500 toward 7,200. A disappointment could pull it toward 7,000. **Place this trade only after Apple's result is known — ideally the morning after.**

ENTRY (AFTER AAPL)	TARGET	STOP LOSS
7,100–7,140	7,250	7,030

Simple Rule to Protect Yourself — The Seatbelt Principle

A stop loss is your financial seatbelt. You do not remove your seatbelt just because you expect the drive to go smoothly. Before you place any trade, decide in advance: "If this goes against me, at what price will I get out?" Enter that number as your stop loss *at the same time* as your trade. Never move it further away from your entry —

only closer. This one habit separates people who survive losses from those who are wiped out by them. On every trade above, a stop loss is included. Use it.

⚠️ **APPLE EARNINGS TONIGHT — STARTER ADVICE**

Apple (AAPL) reports after the US market closes tonight. Earnings announcements create sudden, sharp price moves that can happen in seconds — far faster than you can react. **If you are new to trading, do not hold or enter positions in Apple, Nasdaq, or US tech before this result.** Wait for the dust to settle tomorrow morning. A small position missed is far better than a large position caught in the wrong direction.

3 **Tier 2 — Premium Strategy (\$50,000+ Capital)**

PREMIUM TIER — SOPHISTICATED INVESTORS

Portfolio Allocation & Strategic Positioning

Structured, multi-bucket approach · 3–6 month horizons for safety · Tactical overlays for growth

● **Safety Bucket (50–60% of Portfolio)**

♥️ **Gold (XAU/USD) — Core Strategic Hold**

LOW RISK · 3–6 MONTH

Gold's current dip to \$4,520–\$4,547 is a tactical entry opportunity within a structurally bullish environment. The Iran-oil crisis, ongoing uncertainty around Federal Reserve timing, and a weakening US dollar trend all support gold's continued appreciation. The metal has gained significantly year-to-date. Allocate 20–25% of the safety bucket here with a 6-month target of \$4,800+. This is a hold-through-volatility position — do not react to 1–2% daily swings.

ACCUMULATION ZONE

\$4,440–4,560

6-MONTH TARGET

\$4,800+

STRATEGIC STOP

\$4,200

us S&P 500 Broad Index — Long-Term Core

LOW-MED RISK · 3–6 MONTH

Despite near-term noise, the structural case for US equities remains intact: Magnificent Seven earnings are growing 19% YoY, AI infrastructure investment is accelerating, and the Federal Reserve is on hold — not hiking. Use any pullback to 6,900–7,000 as a strategic add-to opportunity. This position benefits from both earnings growth and potential rate-cut tailwinds in H2 2026. Allocate 25–30% of the safety bucket here.

ACCUMULATE AT

6,900–7,100

6-MONTH TARGET

7,500–7,700

PORTFOLIO STOP

6,600

● **Growth Bucket (30–40% of Portfolio)**

🛢️ **Brent Crude — Tactical Long (Managed)**

MEDIUM RISK · 4–8 WEEK

The Strait of Hormuz situation has no near-term resolution. Iran's refusal to reopen the strait until the US lifts its blockade, combined with Trump's hardening stance, suggests oil remains elevated for weeks. Brent at \$118 can realistically test \$125 if talks remain stalled. Allocate 10–12% of portfolio here with disciplined risk management. Key risk: a sudden diplomatic breakthrough would send oil sharply lower — do not size this position for more than a 12–15% drawdown tolerance.

ENTRY ZONE

\$113–118

TARGET

\$125–130

STOP LOSS

\$107

📡 **Nasdaq 100 / AI Infrastructure — Post-Earnings**

MEDIUM RISK · 6–10 WEEK

The combined \$300B+ AI capex guidance from the Magnificent Seven is the most significant market signal of the quarter. It validates the entire AI infrastructure trade: data centres, semiconductors (Nvidia), power infrastructure,

and cloud services. After Apple's result tonight, if broadly positive, consider adding 12–15% of growth bucket exposure to Nasdaq 100. The AI build-out is a multi-year structural trade — volatility is noise. Nvidia results (later in the cycle) will be the next major catalyst.

ENTRY (POST-AAPL) 21,000–21,500	10-WEEK TARGET 22,500–23,000	STOP LOSS 20,200
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🍏 APPLE EARNINGS TONIGHT — BINARY SCENARIO PLAYBOOK

Apple reports after close. Consensus: EPS \$1.94 | Revenue \$109.7B. The key catalyst is not the headline number — it is management's guidance for Q3 (the iPhone 17 window) and Services gross margin trajectory.

✅ IF BEAT + STRONG GUIDANCE Revenue above \$111B with Services gross margin above 72% and bullish Q3 outlook → Add Nasdaq 100 / Apple CFD at open. Target: Apple to \$215–220. S&P 500 likely surges to 7,250+. Validate within first 30 minutes of post-market trading.	⚠️ IF MISS OR WEAK GUIDANCE Revenue below \$107B or cautious Q3 commentary on tariffs/China sales → Do NOT add tech exposure. Reduce Nasdaq 100 to 5% of growth bucket. Watch for S&P 500 to test 6,950–7,000 support before re-entering. Wait 24–48 hours for clarity.
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Full Portfolio Allocation Summary

Asset	Bucket	Suggested %	Rationale
Gold (XAU/USD)	SAFETY	20–25%	Geopolitical hedge, structural bull run, rate-cut beneficiary
S&P 500 Index	SAFETY	25–30%	Core equity exposure, AI earnings tailwind, 6-month horizon
Brent Crude Oil	GROWTH	10–12%	Iran blockade, Hormuz disruption — short to mid-term elevated
Nasdaq 100	GROWTH	12–15%	AI infrastructure super-cycle, Mag 7 momentum post-earnings
Cash / Buffer	SAFETY	15–20%	Apple reaction optionality, GDP/PCE surprise buffer, dry powder

💎 PREMIUM CLIENT MINDSET

The clients who build wealth through markets share three disciplines: they **enter early** before everyone else understands the trade; they **hold patiently** through the inevitable noise and fear; and they **manage risk relentlessly** — so that a bad day never becomes a catastrophe. The oil situation is noisy, the Apple result is uncertain, and the GDP number today may surprise. None of these are reasons to abandon a well-constructed allocation. They are reasons to check your sizing is appropriate and your stop-loss levels are set. The calm investor, not the reactive one, wins over a 12-month cycle.

4 What to Watch This Week — Risk Events

- US Advance GDP (Today)
- Core PCE Inflation (Today, 2:30 PM ET)
- Apple Earnings (Tonight, After Close)
- Iran–US Strait of Hormuz Talks
- US Jobs Report (Friday, May 1)

We are in one of the most data-dense weeks of the calendar year. Markets have been moving on *expectations* — on hopes about AI growth, hopes about Iran talks, hopes about interest-rate cuts. What makes this week genuinely dangerous is that most of those expectations are now priced in. When an asset is already at a high valuation because everyone expects good news, even a mildly underwhelming result can trigger a sharp sell-off. Think of it as a bicycle tyre inflated just beyond the right pressure — it looks fine, but a small additional stress pops it. The GPS number today will tell us if the US economy is heating up again (bad for rate cuts) or slowing down (good for rate cuts but worrying for earnings). The Employment Cost Index will tell us if wages are still rising — a key inflation signal. And Friday's Non-Farm Payrolls will set the tone for May entirely. In environments like this, position sizing and stop losses are not optional — they are the strategy.

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Indonesia & Malaysia Angle — Talking Points for Client Conversations

The oil story hits Indonesia and Malaysia differently from the rest of the world. Both countries are commodity-related economies — Malaysia exports palm oil and has significant oil and gas revenues; Indonesia exports coal, nickel, and agricultural goods. Higher oil prices are a double-edged sword: they support government revenues for energy producers, but they also raise domestic fuel subsidies and can reignite inflation that central banks thought they had tamed.

For Indonesian clients: the Rupiah has been under pressure against the Dollar at IDR 17,220, which means that assets denominated in USD — including Gold and US index CFDs — have delivered even larger gains in local currency terms than the dollar prices suggest. A client who bought Gold in USD terms six months ago has outperformed simply because of currency dynamics. This is a powerful talking point for dollar-denominated CFD accounts.

The IHSG (Jakarta Composite Index) was trading around 7,080 today, broadly flat with mild positive momentum led by industrials and technology. Indonesian markets have shown relative resilience compared to global peers, supported by commodity revenues. For Malaysian clients, the Ringgit at MYR 3.9465 per dollar has been relatively stable — but sustained oil-driven inflation could prompt Bank Negara to hold rates higher for longer, creating headwinds for property and domestic consumption stocks.

IHSG (JAKARTA COMPOSITE) 7,080 +0.10% · Industrials & Tech leading	USD / IDR 17,220 Rupiah under mild pressure
USD / MYR 3.9465 Ringgit broadly stable	KEY LOCAL RISK Oil & Inflation Fuel subsidy pressure in both markets

Broker Talking Point: "Gold in IDR terms is up significantly this year — your CFD account gains have been amplified by the Rupiah's movement. That is the compounding effect of holding USD-denominated assets in a weaker local currency environment."

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WhatsApp Client Summary — Copy & Send

READY-TO-SEND MESSAGE — 30 APRIL 2026

Good morning. Markets today: Oil surged 7% to \$107 (Brent \$118) as Trump's Iran naval blockade tightens with no end in sight. Gold dipped slightly to \$4,547 — a potential buy opportunity. S&P 500 steady at 7,135. Big tech earnings broadly positive (Microsoft, Meta, Alphabet, Amazon all reported overnight). Tonight: Apple earnings after close and US GDP + inflation data at 2:30pm New York time — expect volatility. Starters: hold off new tech positions until Apple result is confirmed. Premium clients: review oil and gold allocations — contact me to discuss your positioning for May. All trades carry risk; capital at risk.